FOCUSONFORCE

Planning

Understand customer environment risks and articulate appropriate mitigation strategies.

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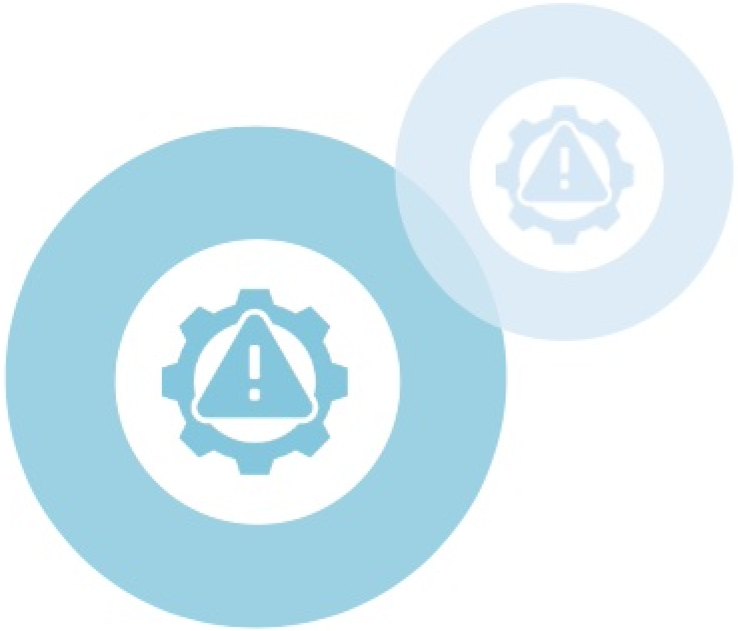
After studying this topic, you should be able to:

- Describe different types of Salesforce environment risks and strategies to mitigate them.
- Identify appropriate mitigation strategies for the given customer environment risks.



Introduction

In Salesforce environments, addressing risks in **customization**, **data security**, **governance**, **project management**, **development**, and **testing** is crucial.

Mitigation strategies involve **user-centered design** and **governance frameworks** for customization, **stringent authentication**, and **encryption** for data security.

Documentation standards and **rigorous testing** address governance issues. **Detailed planning** and **stakeholder engagement** help manage project risks. **Refactoring code** and **prioritizing tasks** mitigate development challenges. Finally, **comprehensive testing strategies** and **using separate environments** address testing risks.

Environment Risks & Mitigation Strategies

Customization Risks

Excessive customization can lead to issues such as unused features. Mitigation strategies such as user-centered design can be adopted.

Project Management Risks

Projects can be affected by issues such as scope creep, which can be mitigated by implementing a Change Control Board.

Development Risks

Development tasks can be affected by risks such as technical debt, which can be mitigated by regularly reviewing and refactoring custom code.

Testing Risks

Testing risks such as lack of isolation due to using a single sandbox can be mitigated by using separate environments or scratch orgs.

Governance Risks

Governance risks can cause issues such as difficulty in maintaining applications. Mitigation strategies such as design standards can be utilized.

Data Security & Privacy Risks

Customer data can be affected by issues such as unauthorized access. Mitigation strategies can focus on controlling access.

Environment Risks & Mitigation Strategies

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Environment Risks & Mitigation Strategies

Appropriate **strategies** can be utilized to mitigate **risks** that are unique to **Salesforce environments**.

Customization Risks

Excessive customization in Salesforce can affect **system performance** and **user experience**. It can lead to many **unused features** and complex dependencies, making **updates** and **integrations challenging**. Customizations can also **conflict with Salesforce updates**, leading to functionality issues.

These risks can be mitigated by implementing a **governance framework** that sets clear guidelines on when and how to customize. **User-centered design** should be adopted to understand user needs. Customizations should be **reviewed regularly** for necessity and efficiency. Outdated or redundant **custom code** should be **refactored** or **removed**.

Environment Risks & Mitigation Strategies

Appropriate **strategies** can be utilized to mitigate **risks** that are unique to **Salesforce environments**.

Data Security and Privacy Risks

Customer data in Salesforce can be affected by **potential breaches** and **unauthorized access**. There may also be **non-compliance with data privacy laws**. These risks can cause lack of customer trust, legal consequences, and financial penalties.

Strong user authentication and authorization practices should be used to control access to sensitive data. **Event Monitoring** can be used to identify unusual data access patterns. **Data encryption** features, such as **Salesforce Shield**, can be used to secure data at rest and in transit. **Data masking** can be used to protect sensitive data in sandboxes.

Environment Risks & Mitigation Strategies

Appropriate **strategies** can be utilized to mitigate **risks** that are unique to **Salesforce environments**.

Governance Risks

Governance risks include **inadequate documentation** and **understanding** of the system's design, **inconsistent development** practices, **inadequate testing** processes, and **poor data quality**. These risks can cause **difficulty in maintaining** and **using applications**. They can also lead to **challenges** related to change management and system integrity.

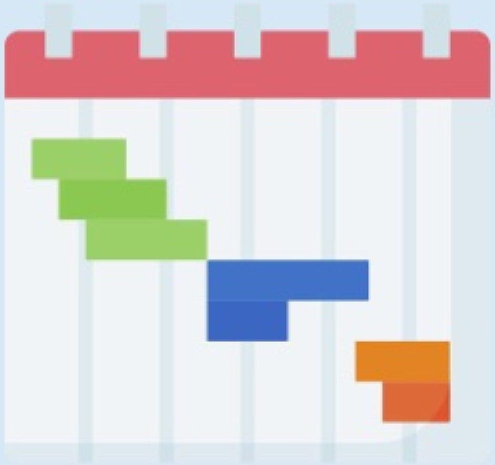
Comprehensive documentation should be maintained about the purpose of custom applications. **Design standards** should be established for custom objects and fields. **Rigorous testing procedures**, **coding standards**, and **review processes** should be implemented. A **data governance framework** should be used to improve and maintain data quality.

Environment Risks & Mitigation Strategies

Appropriate **strategies** can be utilized to mitigate **risks** that are unique to **Salesforce environments**.

Project Management Risks

Major project management risks include **inadequate planning**, **poor requirement gathering**, and **scope creep**. Failure to plan adequately can lead to **budget overruns** and **missed deadlines**. Vague or incomplete requirements can result in **missed objectives** and **wasted resources**. **Scope creep** occurs when the scope expands **beyond the initial boundaries.**



A **comprehensive project plan** with clearly outlined scope, timeline, budget, and resources should be developed for each project. **Thorough requirement gathering** processes, involving key stakeholders, should be utilized. To manage scope creep, a **Change Control Board** can be established. **Change managers** can evaluate and approve change requests.

Environment Risks & Mitigation Strategies

Appropriate **strategies** can be utilized to mitigate **risks** that are unique to **Salesforce environments**.

Development Risks

Some of the major risks related to Salesforce development are **technical debt**, **resource limitations**, and **integration failures**. Technical debt is the accumulation of **inefficient or outdated code**. Insufficient resources can **delay development tasks**. Integration issues can **affect application functionality** and **user experience**.

Custom code should be **reviewed and refactored regularly** while prioritizing clean and maintainable coding practices. Development tasks should be **prioritized** and **assigned** based on **impact** and **urgency**. Integrations should be **tested thoroughly** in a controlled environment, ensuring **compatibility** and **proper error handling**.

Environment Risks & Mitigation Strategies

Appropriate **strategies** can be utilized to mitigate **risks** that are unique to **Salesforce environments**.

Testing Risks

Insufficient test coverage can leave significant functionality untested. **Manual testing** can be time-consuming and prone to human error. **Lack of realistic test data** can mask potential issues in production. **Using the same sandbox for development and testing** results in **lack of isolation** and can cause **functional changes throughout testing**.

Comprehensive testing strategies should be implemented to ensure that all critical paths and functionalities are tested. **Automated testing tools** can be incorporated. **Data masking techniques** can be used to test with secured production data. **Separate sandbox environments** or **scratch orgs** should be used for development and testing.

Business Scenario

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Business Scenario

Read the business scenario below and determine the most appropriate solutions for the company's requirements.

Cosmic Innovations, a prominent Internet Service Provider, faces multifaceted challenges in its Salesforce projects. The company frequently encounters risks related to over-customization leading to maintenance and upgrade issues, data security issues, inadequate governance structures, and project management difficulties.

Furthermore, their development processes suffer from inefficiencies, while their testing practices and procedures are often insufficient to cover all scenarios. To navigate these challenges, the company seeks the expertise of a seasoned Salesforce architect. This professional is tasked with conducting a thorough risk assessment and formulating comprehensive mitigation strategies based on the project requirements.

Requirements & Solutions

Requirement 1

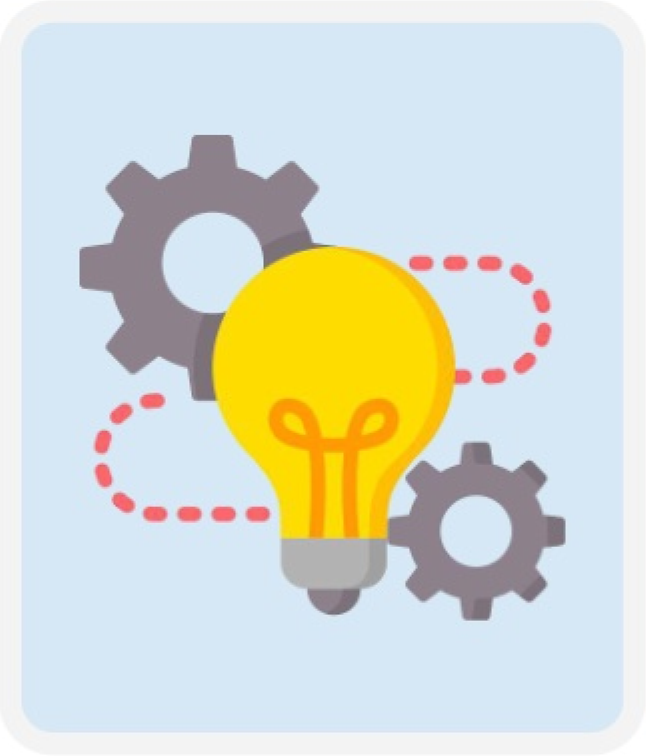
SCENARIO

The company is currently planning a project that involves customizing an existing Salesforce application used for customer data management. However, its assessment of the application has uncovered several risks. Various **unused features** have been identified by analyzing user adoption reports. It is **unclear how custom objects and fields are being used**, which is causing difficulty in managing the application. Also, there are some unauthorized users who are able to **access sensitive customer data**. A comprehensive strategy is required to mitigate these risks before the project can move forward.

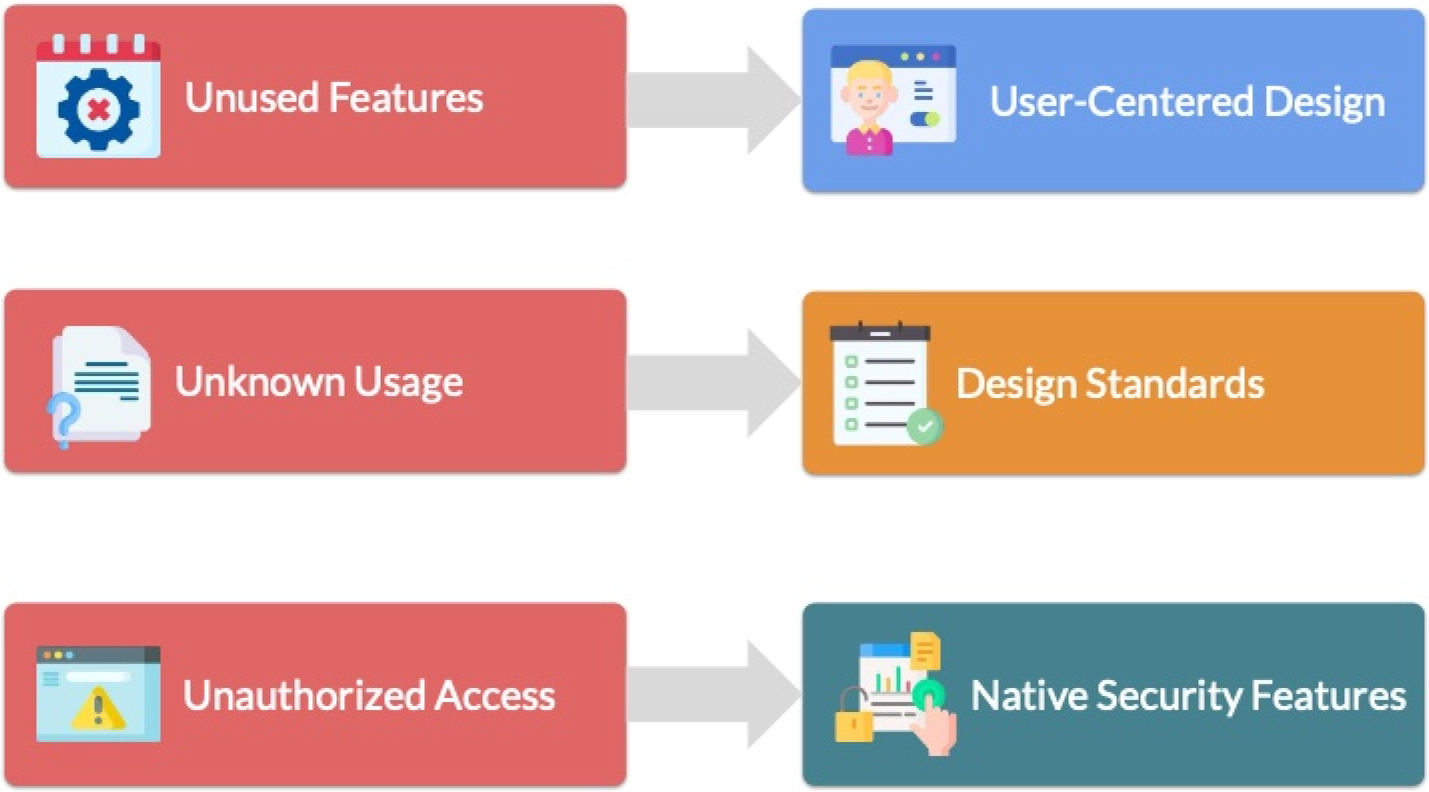
Solution 1

SOLUTION

The company should adopt **user-centered design** to address the issue of unused features. User needs should be identified and understood clearly before customizing the application any further. To improve the maintainability and understanding of custom objects and fields, **design standards** should be created to **require help text** on all custom objects and fields and consistently use the **description field** to specify their purpose. **Profiles, permission sets, and field-level security** should be used to control access to sensitive data. **Shield Platform Encryption** can also be used to secure sensitive data.



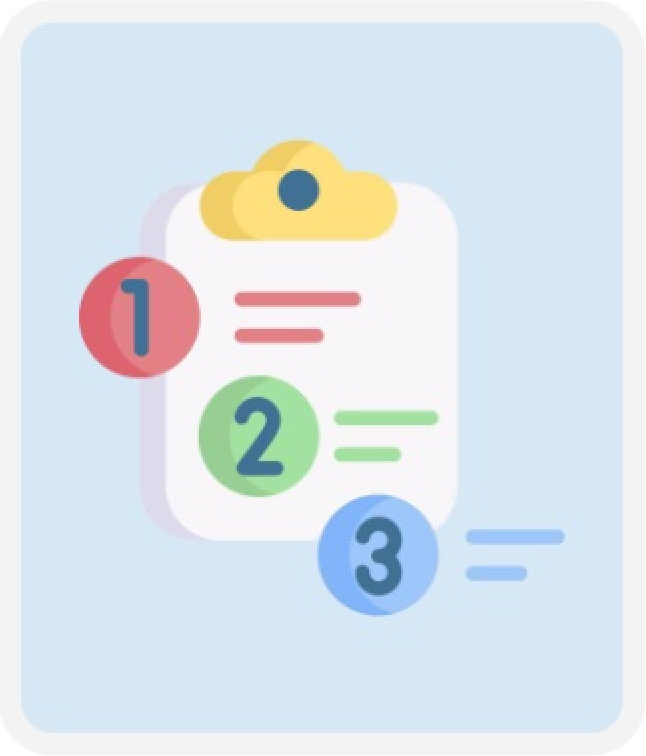
Solution 1


Unused Features
User-Centered Design
Unknown Usage
Design Standards
Unauthorized Access
Native Security Features

Requirement 2

SCENARIO

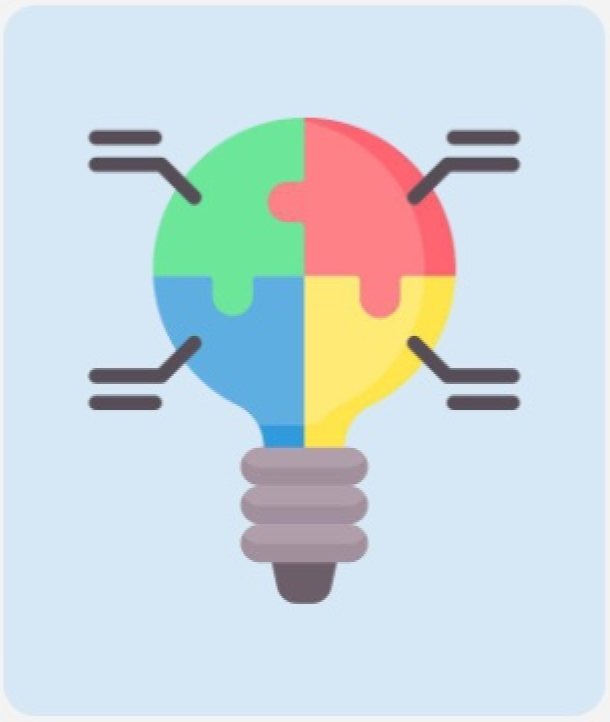
A development team within the company has been tasked with working on a project for the IT department. A new custom application is required in Salesforce to allow IT support staff to manage internal support requests. The project's budget and release date have been set, but the **precise requirements are still unknown**. In addition, the project manager is concerned about **scope creep** due to her past experience with similar projects. Also, due to limited sandbox licenses and several development streams, she has insisted the **use of a single sandbox for development and testing**.



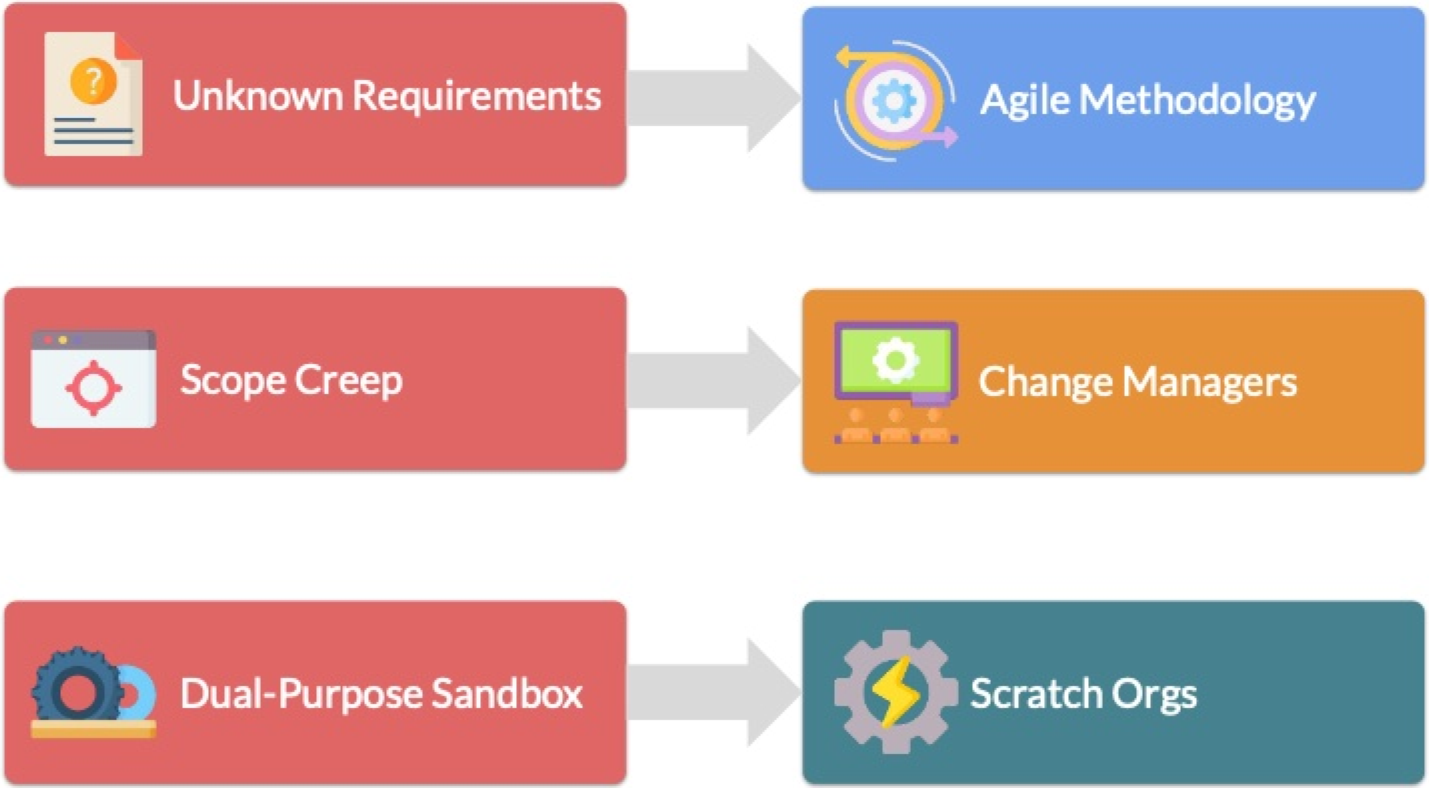
Solution 2

SOLUTION

To mitigate the risk of proceeding with unknown requirements, an **agile methodology** could be adopted, which would accommodate evolving requirements while maintaining control over the project's timeline and budget. Scope creep can be managed by establishing a **Change Control Board**. **Change managers** can review, approve, and prioritize change requests based on their impact and urgency. Using a single sandbox for development and testing can result in testers experiencing **functional changes throughout testing** due to lack of isolation. **Scratch orgs** can be utilized for isolated testing due to limited sandbox licenses.



Solution 2


Unknown Requirements
Agile Methodology
Scope Creep
Change Managers
Dual-Purpose Sandbox
Scratch Orgs

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